

Buying things in prison

Unit 1

Buying from a catalogue



Contents

Unit 1 Buying from a catalogue teacher's notes

Unit 1 Buying from a catalogue learner resources

Unit 1 Buying from a catalogue answers

Overview

Unit 1 Buying things in Prison teacher's notes

This unit focuses on prisoners making purchases from catalogues with their private money and provides the opportunity to build vocabulary relating to formal language and clothes. It includes some practical form filling and letter writing practice with a focus on grammar, punctuation and spelling. Key language is presented in practical worksheets with a focus on what is required in prison to make purchases, and how to make formal requests to governors. Learners will use this language by writing their own formal letters to the governor and filling in a prison style form for catalogue purchases.

Time: 90 minutes plus extensions.

Level: Entry level 1-3 / Scottish Nati 2 – National 4 / CEFR A1 – B1

Aims

For all learners:

- to introduce /revise language used in catalogues and to do with clothing from
- to improve spelling of clothing items
- to promote better communications between learners and staff with a better understanding of formal language and requests.

Entry 2 and above

- to develop vocabulary used in formal contexts
- to develop detailed reading skills in the context of catalogues and forms
- to use authentic forms to develop form filling skills
- to develop grammatical structures used in formal letters of request.

Objectives

All learners will be able to:

- fill in an application form for personal purchases

- use a wider range of vocabulary to request personal purchases of clothing e. g. 'I would like to buy a coat'
- read and understand a prison order form for special purchases
- write a simple formal letter of request.

Some learners will be able to:

- write detailed formal letters of requests with relevant grammar, punctuation and spelling.

Preparation

You will need:

- **Resource 1a** – one for each learner.
- **Resource 1 b** – one cut up for each learner at Entry 1/2
- **Resource 2** – one for each learner. You could cut it into 3 parts and just give the first task to learners at lower levels.
- **Resource 3a** for learners at lower levels, 3b for learners at Entry 2/3, 3c for higher levels
- **Resource 4** - one for each learner.
- **Resource 5** - one for each learner
- **Resource 6a** - cut-up for all learners
- **Resource 6b** – one copy for each learners at Entry 1 / 2
- Catalogues and apps for ordering catalogue items used in your prison
- Scissors or cut up before the session.

Suggested Procedure

Warmer

- Initiate class discussion about the clothes they are wearing to elicit vocabulary of clothing.

Activity 1 – Vocabulary development

- Hand out **resource 1a**, focus learners on the model answers and ask why there is a line between the words and the pictures.
- Ask learners to label the pictures.

Differentiation

- For learners at lower levels, cut the names of the clothing from **resource 1b** into individual labels that they can either place on the items of clothing in the images or copy them and draw a line to the appropriate picture.
- You may want to give fewer labels to learners with limited literacy.
- Learners at Entry 3 could label the items independently without looking at **resource 1b**. You could also challenge fast-finishers to think of alternative names for items eg jumper/sweater/woolly

Activity 2 – Grammar and spelling

- Either hold up an image of an article of clothing eg *jumper, apron, trousers*, or an actual item and elicit what the item is. Nominate a learner to spell the word and write it on the right of the board. Pause if they give you the wrong letter and support them to decide on the correct one.
- Next elicit the article that goes with each word. You could do this by using it in a short sentence pausing where the article goes eg '*I need ____ apron*' '*I buy trousers from...*'
- Discuss articles a/an/Ø.
- Hand out **resource 2** and check that learners know what the items on the sheet are.
- Ask all learners to complete task 1 and then check their answers with a partner at the same level. Nominate learners in turn to give the answer to each item. Ask if everyone agrees.
- Learners could then do the next task and compare their answers with a partner, or in groups of three.
- Fast finishers could complete the third (spelling) task.
- Display the table on the Interactive White Board (IWB) if you have one read out each item and nominate a learner to give the answer.
- Check that everyone agrees to identify learners who need further help.

Tip – all learners will be able to complete part, if not all, of this worksheet as the vocabulary has already been provided.

Activity 3 – language in catalogues

- Initiate class discussion: '*How can you order items that are not on the canteen sheet?*'
- Elicit the process from learners who are familiar with it. Write each step they need to follow on the board to support learners who are not familiar with the process, checking understanding as you do so.
- If you have been able to get copies of the catalogue/s available in your establishment, hold one up and elicit what it is, its purpose and if they have ever used it. Tell them if they don't know.
- Do the same with the 'app' they need to use to order items.
- Concept check understanding of the function of catalogues and apps by asking these questions:
 - '*What is in this (indicating the catalogue)?*' (Possible answers: '*A book with things you buy,*' '*Pictures and information about things you can buy.*')
 - '*Why do you look in this?*' (Possible answer: '*To order things you want/ need.*')

- 'How do you order things from the catalogue?' (Possible answer: 'You need to fill in an / the app.')
- If you have multiple copies of the catalogue ask learners, in pairs or small groups of three or four, to open a page with various text features.
- Draw their attention to these *features* highlighting key terms and abbreviations such as sizes, order numbers, descriptions. Ask questions like 'I want to buy a jumper – 'where can I find it? How much does it cost?' Make sure you cover all the vocabulary in **resources 3a** and **b**.
- Then hand out **resource 3a** or **3b** to learners according to their level (3a is lower level) and model the first answer for each group. Allow learners to complete the questions independently, monitoring and supporting where necessary..
- Ask learners to compare their answers with a partner at a similar level, then go over them as a group, nominating learners to give the correct answers.

Differentiation

- You may need to work with learners with literacy needs and just do the first task on **resource 3a**, while the others work independently or in mixed ability pairs.
- Fast finishers can do task 3 on **resource 3b**

Activity 4 – form filling

- Ask learners what 3 pieces of information they must always put on an application form
 - full name
 - prison number
 - wing
- Hand out **resource 4** and go over the model answer. Ask questions to check understanding e.g. *What's the first thing on the form?* (Possible answer: 'Jeans')
- Elicit what 'official use' means and that they shouldn't write on this part,
- Learners complete the task by ordering up to four items from **resource 3a**, with those at the lower levels ordering just one item with your, or a more advanced learner's support.
- Learners can check each other's order forms for accuracy.

Tip – this could be used as an addition task for totalling the order and focusing on the pronunciation of money/numbers.

Differentiation

Learners at lower levels can fill in the form in pairs taking it in turns to write and helping each other.



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Activity 5 – formal letters

- Sometimes prisoners have to write a letter to the governor to request permission to purchase certain items.
- Elicit what learners know about the language used to write an informal letter to a friend and how that is different from what they would use in a formal letter.
- Discuss items or requests that would require special permission in your prison while eliciting formal and informal language. Write their suggestions on the board under the headings 'formal' and 'informal'. If necessary suggest examples to them e.g. 'hi' 'ok' 'love' 'cheers' 'ta' 'dear' 'sir' 'sincerely' and so on.
- Ask what else they should consider e.g. grammar, spelling, punctuation, no expletives, neat writing.
- Establish that they understand that they would have to write a formal letter to a governor.
- Hand out **resource 5** and discuss formal language for writing to a governor. Check all learners understand the meaning of the words in the boxes.
- Allow learners time to complete the vocabulary exercises.

Activity 6 – reconstructing a letter

- Tell the learners that they are going to reconstruct a letter from Mustafa to a governor, to ask permission to buy a coat with the money in his personal spends account. Give the phrases and sentences cut up from **resource 6a** to learners to reconstruct the letter.
- Give all the phrases to the more advanced learners and tell them that three of the phrases which should not be included in the letter. Give learners at lower levels only the correct phrases.
- Ask them to compare answers. Monitor and support noting any issues to come back to.
- Ask learners to write a letter to the governor requesting permission to buy items requiring special permission.
- Encourage peer correction – learners check each other's letters and underline any words or phrases they think are wrong. Monitor and support to ensure the correct formalities are used.

Tip – if there are no items requiring permission in your prison, write the letter anyway to practise formal writing.

Differentiation

Learners at lower levels could complete the **resource 6b** formal letter, gap fill exercise. They can use it as a model to write their formal letter.

Higher level learners can write a more detailed letter to include conjunctions such as: therefore, although, as; but, for example. Grade the conjunctions used according to your learners' levels. List the conjunctions on the board and elicit when to use each one and ask learners to use as many as they can (or specify a number) in their letter.

Follow-up or extension activities

Activity 7 – Error correction

- Hand out **resource 7a** (higher level) **and 7b** (lower level) for learners to find the mistakes in grammar, punctuation, vocabulary or spelling.
- Lower level learners could be instructed to find the vocabulary in the text to match the pictures at the bottom of the sheet.
- You could allow all learners to attempt the whole text and differentiate by the numbers of mistakes they are expected to find. This is not an exact science and allows lower level learners to be motivated to find as many as they can.
- This could be used as a spring board activity to focus on punctuation, spelling or grammar issues that become apparent from this task. For example, if there is a lack of understanding about short forms in formal letters, this could be an opportunity to build on short forms, or if there is a lack of understanding about commas, this could be built upon.

Cooler Vocabulary bingo.

The vocabulary used is from the lesson and paired with a minimal pair to practise spelling, pronunciation and listening skills. Depending on the time remaining you can focus more or less on the pronunciation and listening skills.

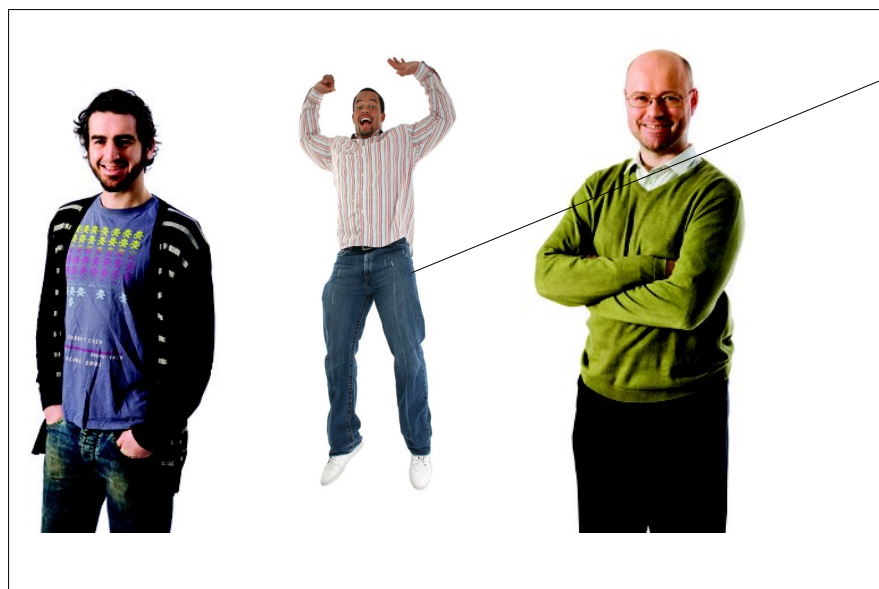
- Give the 8 bingo cards to hand to individual students.
- If you have more than 8 students, two learners can share a copy.
- One learner to call the words one at a time, for the listener to mark off on their card.
- Once a learner has completed a line in any direction: vertical, horizontal or diagonal, they win.
- The winner then calls the words in the next game.

Tip – if learners mark the card in pencil they can rub out the marks and use the same card again. Or you can cut up counters to put over numbers called out.

Resource 1a clothing vocabulary



coat



jeans



Resource 1b **clothing vocabulary**

jacket	coat
jeans	suit
tie	bag
trousers	shirt
t-shirt	jumper
shorts	trainers
long-sleeved	short-sleeved
hooded jacket	sweatshirt
shoes	scarf
cardigan	belt

Resource 2 Articles and spelling

We use:

- a – when we are talking about an item starting with a consonant
 - an – when we are talking about an item starting with a vowel
 - Ø – no article when we use a plural
- a jumper an apron trousers

Now put a, an, Ø, into the following list.

- 1a) A t-shirt
- b) ____ jeans
- c) ____ umbrella
- d) ____ hoodie
- e) ____ shirt
- f) ____ shoes
- g) ____ suit
- h) ____ apron
- i) ____ tie

2) Match the word with the picture. Use the correct article.



football boots dressing gown	tie wellington boots (wellies)	shirt jeans
---------------------------------	-----------------------------------	----------------

3) Put the letters in the correct order to spell the names of clothes.

- a) ssoeh shoes
- b) tosob _____
- c) gdesrsni owgn _____
- d) eti _____
- e) tolafobl tsobo _____
- f) riths _____
- g) leweisl _____
- h) nejas _____
- i) tiksr _____
- j) kajcte _____

Resource 3a vocabulary in catalogues

There is a lot of information in a catalogue.
 When they describe things they use a lot of short words. We call these short words, abbreviations.
 Take a look at some examples below to see what they mean.

	Product summary	
	Striped design jumper, front and back.	→ Description
	Available in sizes XS, S, M.	→ Size
	Composition: 100% cotton.	
	Machine washable at 40°C	
	PON: 589632	→ Product number
	Price: £9.99	→ Price

Match the information needed on the left, with the information on the right.

- | | | | |
|---|----------------|---|--------------------|
| 1 | Product number | ← | medium |
| 2 | Description | → | PON456258 |
| 3 | Size | | grey cotton jumper |
| 4 | Unit cost | | £9.99 |

When they describe clothes they can be XS, S, M, L, XL, XXL. X means extra, S means small, L means large.

Can you match the size with the abbreviation?

- | | | | |
|----|-------------------|---|-----|
| 5 | large | ↖ | XS |
| 6 | Small | | XL |
| 7 | Extra small | | M |
| 8 | Extra large | | XXL |
| 9 | Medium | | S |
| 10 | Extra extra large | ↘ | L |

Resource 3b

vocabulary in catalogues

When you want to order something from a catalogue, you need to give lots of details. What details do you think you will need?



Product summary		
Striped design jumper, front and back.		Description
• Available in sizes XS, S, M.		Size
• Composition: 100% cotton.		Product number
• Machine washable at 40°C		
• PON: 589632		
• Price: £9.99		Unit cost

Match the information needed on the left, with the information on the right.

1	Product number	medium
2	Page number	£9.99
3	Description	PON456258
4	Size	grey cotton jumper
5	Quantity	101
6	Unit cost	£18.98
7	Total cost	2

Some items do not need all of this information. If you are ordering a tie, there will not be a size.

- 8 When the information is not in the catalogue, what would you put on the form?
 - a) Nothing
 - b) Make up a size
 - c) n/a
- 9 What do you think n/a means?

The vocabulary we use when we are talking about size is different, depending on the item. Shoe sizes can be size 4 – 14(UK), or 37 – 48(EU)

Clothes can be small, medium, large, extra-large, or in inches or centimetres.

- 10 What do S, M, L, XL, mean when talking about size?
- 11 What does W34, L36 mean when talking about a pair of trousers?
- 12 Is the measurement in inches or centimetres in question 11?

Resource 3c vocabulary in catalogues

There is a lot of information in a catalogue.
 When they describe things they use a lot of short words. We call these short words, abbreviations.
 Take a look at some examples below to see what they mean.

	Product summary	
	Striped design jumper, front and back.	→ Description
	Available in sizes XS, S, M.	→ Size
	Composition: 100% cotton.	
	Machine washable at 40°C	
	PON: 589632	→ Product number
	Price: £9.99	→ Price

Match the information needed on the left, with the information on the right.

- | | | | |
|---|----------------|---|--------------------|
| 1 | Product number | ← | medium |
| 2 | Description | → | PON456258 |
| 3 | Size | | grey cotton jumper |
| 4 | Unit cost | | £9.99 |

When they describe clothes they can be XS, S, M, L, XL, XXL. X means extra, S means small, L means large.

Can you match the size with the abbreviation?

- | | | | |
|----|-------------------|---|-----|
| 5 | large | ↖ | XS |
| 6 | Small | | XL |
| 7 | Extra small | | M |
| 8 | Extra large | | XXL |
| 9 | Medium | | S |
| 10 | Extra extra large | ↘ | L |

Resource 3c vocabulary in catalogues

Here is an example of a page from a catalogue that you can order from in prison. Take a look, and answer the questions.

 Product summary Indigo Sandblast jeans. Composition: 100% cotton. Machine washable at 40°C. Size: S, M, L PON: 123852 Cost £20	 Product summary Classic and fresh work shoe. These high top work shoes come in brown and black. Composition: Outer: other. Inner: other. Sole: other. Size: 6-15 PON: 123852 Cost: £40	 Product summary This cotton apron has an adjustable neck for your comfort and will protect your clothing when cooking. Red cotton apron. Adjustable neck. Size W76, L85cm. PON: 789456
 Product summary Men's waterproof jacket. Stylish and comfortable. Available in sizes: small. 100% polyester with PVC coating. Lining: 100% polyester. Machine washable at 40°C. PON: 741456 Cost: £30	 Product summary Wellington boots. Composition: Outer: other. Inner: textile. Sole: other. Wipe clean. Available in sizes: 5 to 9. PON: 2586010 Cost: £15	 Product summary Designed in London. If you're feeling the chill, this hoodie is perfect. It comes in a chic charcoal or light grey. Available in sizes S, M, L, XL. Composition: 60% cotton, 40% polyester. Machine washable at 30°C. PON: 963258 Cost: £25

199

1. What is the page number for the wellies? _____
2. What size is the jacket? _____
3. Can you order the apron in blue? _____
4. Can you get the jeans in extra-large? _____
5. What word means the material that the item is made from? _____
6. How many colours is the hoodie available in? _____

Resource 4 form filling in prison

Full name _____ prison number _____ wing _____

To Be Completed By The Prisoner								Official Use Only			
	Supplier I.e. Argos, M&M	Full catalogue number	Page number	description	Size	Quantity	Unit cost (£)	Total cost (£)	Approved by stores	Money deducted by finance	Item received
1	Argos	PON: 123852	199	Indigo sandblast jeans	small	1	£20				
2											
3											
4											
5											
Postage and administration fee							£1.00				
Total cost of order (incl above fees)											

Signed _____

Date submitted _____



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Resource 5 formal language in letters

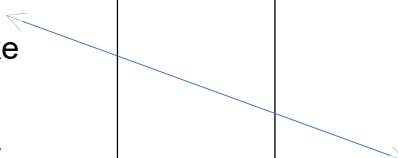
When we write letters to our friends we use informal language.

When we write letters to solicitors, governors, councils, employers, we use formal language.

Do you know the difference between informal and formal language?

- 1) Look at the list of words used in letters in list (a), and match them to the words with the same meaning in list (b).

(a)	(b)
Dear	can
Would like	Bye
request	want
suggest	Hi
permission	tell
Sincerely	allow



- 2) Which list of words would you use in a formal letter: a or b? _____

Below is an example of a letter written by a prisoner to his Governor, to request extra gym sessions.

- 3) Do you think this is a good letter? _____

- 4) Why/why not? _____

Governor Spa HMP York Dear Sir, I would like to request permission to attend an extra gym session each week. My health has not been good and health care suggest that it would be good for me. I look forward to your reply. Yours sincerely B Abdul	A1234NY B. Abdul HMP York
--	--

Learner worksheet 6a

Activity 6 a– formal language in letters

Below is a letter Mustafa writes to a governor, to request permission to buy a coat with the money in his personal spends account.

1. Three of the sections are wrong, which three are they?
2. Why are they wrong?

Dear Governor Simms,	Hi governor,
but I get very cold walking around the grounds.	to buy a new coat
with the money in my personal spends account.	I would like to ask permission
and I get very cold walking around the grounds.	A44444AN
There is enough money in my account	Thank you
The weather is getting cold now that winter is here	Thanks mate
because my family sent some in to me.	Yours sincerely
	Mustafa Abdul

3. Now write a letter to your Governor, requesting permission to buy something from a catalogue. You can write it on the back of this worksheet.

Resource 6 formal letter: gap fill.

Complete the gaps in the letter below with the words in the box, to make a formal letter.

Dear Governor,

The (a)_____ is getting cold now, (b)_____ I would like to buy a coat to keep warm.

I have money in my (c) _____ account that I would like to use.

(d)_____ can I have your (e) _____ to buy this.

Yours (f)_____

Chiko Farah

(g)_____

~~Governor~~
weather

spends
permission

and

Please
A1199AN

Resource 7a

Activity 7a – find the mistakes

There are a lot of mistakes in the letter below. Read it and mark the mistakes with **g** for grammar **p** for punctuation, **s** for spelling and **v** for vocabulary

How many mistakes can you find?

Hi governor

I am a enhanced prisoner in this prison, and have been enhanced for 2 years. This is because I am a very good person and keep out of truble.

Because I have been in prison a long time, I need new clothes. I have £500 in my spends' account which I would like to use.

The clothes I want to buy are for the winter. It is geting cold now and I need a new coat. My last one got nicked when I was in my last prison.

I want new trainers because the ones I have are worn out, they have a hole in the soul. Also I would like new underwear because mine is horrid. It's been washed so many times that it is falling apart. So, I would like new pants and some vests for the winter, to keep me walm

Finally, I would like to buy some new jumper. All my jumpers were ruined in a fawlty washing mashine so now I do not have any, therefore I would like to buy some more.

Thank you for reading my request and I look forward to your reply.

Yours Sincerely

Atif Yassim
A3698AN





Resource 7b – find the mistakes

1. Hi governor
2. I am a enhanced prisoner in this prison. I am very good person and keep out of trouble.
3. I have been in prison a long time, I nid new clothes.
4. I have £500 in spends' account which I can use.
5. I want to buy clothes for the winter. It is geting cold now and I need a new coat.
6. i need new trainers because mine are worn out.
7. Also I would like new underwear because mine is horrid.
8. I would like new pants and some vests for the winter, to keep me walm
9. I want buy some new jumper. All my jumpers were ruined in a faulty washing mashine so now I do not have any.
10. Thank you for reading my request and I look forward to your reply.
11. Yours Sincerely

Atif Yassim
A3698AN

Can you spot the mistakes?

- | | |
|---------|---|
| Line 1 | 1 vocabulary and 1 punctuation mistake |
| Line 2 | 2 grammar mistakes |
| Line 3 | 1 spelling mistake |
| Line 4 | 1 grammar mistake |
| Line 5 | 1 spelling mistake |
| Line 6 | 1 punctuation mistake |
| Line 7 | 1 vocabulary mistake |
| Line 8 | 1 spelling mistake |
| Line 9 | 2 grammar mistakes and 1 spelling mistake |
| Line 11 | 1 punctuation mistake |





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Learner worksheet 9

Activity 8 – vocabulary bingo, minimal pairs

Cut/tear out the 8 cards to hand to individual students.

shirt	tie	short
shoes	choose	lie
lose	jeans	cost
lie		
shoes	choose	shirt
cost	jeans	beans

shirt	tie	short
shoes	lost	lie
lose	choose	beans
shirt		
beans	choose	lost
lose	jeans	shoes

shirt	short	tie
shoes	choose	lie
lose	jeans	beans

shirt		
lose	choose	lie
shoes	jeans	beans

beans	tie	short
shoes	choose	lie
lose	jeans	shirt
shirt		
shoes	choose	tie
lose	jeans	beans

Unit 1 Buying things in prison answers

Resource 2

- 1) Ø c) an d) a e) a f) Ø g) a h) an i) a
 2) dressing gown b) wellington boots (wellies) c) football boots d) tie e) jeans f) shirt
 3) boots c) dressing gown d) tie e) football boots f) shirt g) wellies h) jeans i) skirt j) jacket

Resource 3a

Resource 3b

- 2) page number – 101 3) description – grey cotton jumper 4) size – medium
 5) quantity – 2 6) unit cost - £9.99 7) total cost - £18.98 8) d 9) not applicable 10) small, medium, large, extra large 11) waist, leg 12) inches

Resource 3c

- 1) 199 14) small 2) no 3) no 4) composition 5) 2

Resource 5

1) Would like – want, request – can, suggest – tell, permission – allow, sincerely – bye

2) a

5) Dear Governor Simms,

I would like to ask permission/to buy a new coat/ with the money in my personal spends account./

The weather is getting cold now that winter is here/ and I get very cold walking around the grounds./

There is enough money in my account/ because my family sent some in to me./

Thank you./

Yours sincerely, /

Mustafa Abdul/

A44444AN/

6) Hi governor: but I get very cold walking around the grounds: thanks mate.

7) hi, informal: but, wrong conjunction: thanks mate, informal.

Resource 6

a) weather b) and c) spends d) please e) permission f) sincerely g) A1199AN

Resource 7a

Dear (v1) **Governor** (p1)

I am **an** (g1) enhanced prisoner in this prison, and have been enhanced for 2 years. This is because I am **a** (g 2) very good person and keep out of **trouble**(s1) .

Because I have been in prison a long time, I need new clothes. I **have** (g3) £500 in my spends account which I would like to use.

The clothes I want to buy are for the winter. It is **getting**(s2) cold now and I need a new coat. My last one was **stolen** (v2) in my last prison.

I **would like** (v3) new trainers because the ones I have are worn out, they have a hole in the **sole** (s3). **Also**, (p2 comma) I would like new underwear because mine is **worn out** (v4). It **has** (g4) been washed so many times that it is falling apart. So, I would like new pants and some vests for the winter, to keep me **warm**(s4).(p3 full stop after warm.)

Finally, I would like to buy some new jumpers (g5). All my jumpers were ruined in a **faulty** (s5) washing **machine**(s6), (p4 comma after machine) so now I do not have any and I would like to buy some more.

Thank you for reading my request, and I look forward to your reply.

Your **sincerely**(p5)

Atif Yassim

A3698AN

Resource 7b

1. Hi governor / **Dear Governor**
2. I am **an** enhanced prisoner in this prison. I am **a** very good person and keep out of trouble.
3. I have been in prison a long time, I **need** new clothes.
4. I have £500 in **my** spends account which I can use.
5. I want to buy clothes for the winter. It is **getting** cold now and I need a new coat.
6. I need new trainers because the mine are worn out.
7. Also I would like new underwear because **mine is worn out**.
8. I would like new pants and some vests for the winter, to keep me **warm**
9. I want **to** buy some new jumpers. All my jumpers were ruined in a faulty washing **machine** so now I do not have any.
10. Thank you for reading my request and I look forward to your reply.
11. Yours **sincerely**